STORY 5 New Words • The Stone That Fed a Village

1 **traveller** ['trævələ] *n.* — путешественник, путник
A person who is going from one place to another place.
→ The traveller slept in a different village every night.

2 **stir** [stɜ:] *v.* — мешать, размешивать
To move food or liquid around with a spoon.
→ She stirred the sugar into her hot tea.

3 **boil** [bɔɪl] *v.* — кипеть, варить
When water becomes very hot and makes bubbles.
→ Wait until the water boils, then put the rice in.

4 **taste** [teɪst] *v.* — пробовать (на вкус)
To eat or drink a little, to find out how good something is.
→ Taste the soup and tell me if it needs salt.

5 **spoon** [spu:n] *n.* — ложка
You eat soup with it.
→ He ate the soup with a big wooden spoon.

6 **onion** ['ʌnjən] *n.* — лук (одна луковица)
A round vegetable with a very strong smell.
→ My eyes always cry when I cut an onion.

7 **lid** [lɪd] *n.* — крышка
The top part of a pot or a box, which you can take off.
→ Put the lid on the pot and wait ten minutes.

8 **delicious** [dɪ'lɪʃəs] *adj.* — очень вкусный
Very, very good to eat.
→ Your grandmother's bread is delicious.

9 **share** [ʃeə] *v.* — делиться
To give a part of something to other people.
→ Five friends shared one small pizza.

10 **gather** ['gæðə] *v.* — собираться (вместе)
To come together in one place.
→ The whole family gathered around the table.

11 **magic** ['mædʒɪk] *n. / adj.* — волшебство; волшебный
A special power that can do impossible things.
→ In the story the old man had a magic ring.

Useful phrases from the story

tell the truth — говорить правду
Not one of the ten people told the truth.

change your mind — передумать
She wanted to say no, but then she changed her mind.

The Stone That Fed a Village

A **traveller** came into the village as the sun was going down. He had walked all day and his bag was empty. He knocked on the first door.

"I am hungry," he said. "Please give me a little bread."

"We have nothing," the woman answered. "The winter was long." Then she shut the door.

He knocked on ten more doors, and ten people said the same words, and not one of them **told the truth**. The traveller had a very good nose. Behind those doors he could smell **onions**, and meat, and warm bread.

He did not ask again. He walked down to the river and chose a small round stone. He washed it in the cold water, slowly and carefully, like something very important.

"A stone like this," he said quietly, "is going to make dinner for a whole village."

In the middle of the village he made a fire. He asked old Anvar for a big black pot. A pot is not food, so Anvar gave it with a smile. The traveller filled the pot with water, dropped the stone inside, and began to **stir**.

A boy came first. "What are you cooking?"

"Stone soup," said the traveller. "Tomorrow this whole village will talk about it."

The water **boiled**. A small crowd stood around the fire and watched. The traveller took a big wooden **spoon**, **tasted** the soup and closed his eyes.

"It is going to be good," he said. "It will be very good. But a stone soup is always better with one **onion**."

"I think I have an onion," a woman said. She ran home and came back with three.

The traveller cut them in and tasted again. "Wonderful. A little salt will make it perfect."

The salt arrived. Then a man whispered something to his wife, and two eggs arrived. Then some rice. Then a small piece of meat, from a family who had told the traveller, one hour before, that they had nothing at all.

Nobody wanted to be the one who gave nothing. One by one, the neighbours **changed their minds**.

The traveller put the **lid** on the pot. "Now we are going to wait," he said. "In twenty minutes we will eat."

They waited. The soup was **delicious**. The village **shared** it, and everybody **gathered** close to the fire, and somebody began to sing, and the children went to bed far too late.

"It is a **magic** stone," the people said. The traveller only smiled.

In the morning he washed the stone again and put it in his bag. The boy was watching him.

"Will you tell me the secret?" the boy asked. "Is it really magic?"

The traveller put the stone into the boy's hand. "It is not the stone," he said. "But keep it. It works best in a village that says it has nothing."

Then he walked away down the cold road.

